

Bazaar

mini ^{QUICK} INSIGHTS FROM INDEPTH TESTS

The Digit Test Centre receives hundreds of products every month. Each of these products is put through a series of tests, and are finally given a verdict. The final score is arrived at after considering a number of factors and evaluating them in terms of features, performance, value for money, build quality, and in the case of software even ease of use.

For better understanding of our ratings, here's a quick guide to our overall score

- 1.0 - 3.0 - Extremely poor product. Keep away!
- 3.5 - 5.0 - Strictly OK. Not recommended
- 5.5 - 6.5 - Decent product. Go for it, but there maybe better products.
- 7.0 - 8.5 - Very good product. Highly recommended.
- 9.0-10.0 - Ground-breaking product. We've never seen anything like it before. A definite must buy!



Samsung Galaxy Tab 8.9

Samsung introduced the 9 inch Galaxy Tab 8.9, which will run TouchWiz, Samsung's own skinned version of Android 3.0 Honeycomb.

COLOUR LASER MFD



Ricoh SP C232SF
Price: ₹ 56,000



Samsung CLX-3186FN
Price: ₹ 29,499

SPECIFICATIONS

Resolution 600 x 600dpi
Network Support Yes
Dimension (WxDxH)..... 420 x 493 x 476
Weight 30 kg

Resolution 1200 x 1200 dpi
Network Support Yes
PictBridge Yes
Dimension (WxDxH)..... 416 x 378 x 344

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features..... 6.0
It is a laser colour MFD which supports duplex printing, copying and scanning. There is a 2-line LCD display which is backlit.

Performance 6.5
It took 35 secs for a quality text print, 47 secs for quality mixed document print. Photo printing on a glossy paper gave many problems.

Build quality 8.0
It has an extremely sturdy build with responsive buttons.

Value for money 6.0
At ₹56,000 this MFD makes sense in a medium sized office.

Features..... 7.5
Samsung CLX-3186 is a colour laser MFD. It supports PictBridge and has an Eco button for one-touch print.

Performance 7.0
Quality mixed document print took 30 secs whereas a quality photo print took 51 secs. Photo quality was not as good as that of the mixed document.

Build quality 7.0
Build quality is quite good and it has a small footprint for an MFD.

Value for money..... 6.0
Pricing at ₹29,499 is quite decent for a laser printer.

WE SAY

6.5

Although we found the C232SF to be slow with quality printing, the output was quite good. Ricoh C232SF does its job well. Although we did find 35 secs and 47 secs to print quality text and mixed document a bit much, but the quality is flawless. Scanning and copying was snappy. It took over 30 secs to get working if it was in sleep mode. Operating the 2-line LCD display is not a very user friendly experience. Glossy paper kept getting jammed though which we found surprising. At ₹56,000 this MFD makes sense in a medium office setup.

7.0

Samsung CLX-3186FN is a fast laser MFD with a beautiful minimalist design and a splash of colour on the operational panel. It gave good quality prints except for the photograph. Operational panel is quite user friendly. With the laser toner cartridge priced at ₹8,000 giving 1500 prints, it works out a bit on the higher side as compared to HP 8500A inkjet printer. Due to the higher toner cost, the total operating cost is quite high for this MFD.